Why hasn't Coca-Cola sued this church yet?

The Church of Conceptual Art published its litigation strategy as scripture, waived the defense of irony, and is waiting.

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THE STORY

The Art Bible of the Church of Conceptual Art, Volume I: The Great Deprecation (2026) is a real book with a real Library of Congress record, catalogued under the subject heading New Corporate Realism (Art movement). Its cover sets the church's monogram, CoCA, in a flowing script the whole world knows. The question the book then spends 148 pages arming is the obvious one: why hasn't the owner of that script sued?

The answer begins on the book's legal page. Where other books print a copyright notice, the Bible prints a "Notice of Proprietary Dominion & Theological Compliance," document class "Sacred Instrument / Binding Covenant." It asserts dual sovereignty: the text is registered under the Copyright Act of 1976, but "such registration is merely a secular formality," and where intellectual property law conflicts with the Spiritual Will of the Institution, "the latter shall be deemed the Supreme Law of the Case." Infringers face two remedy classes: civil damages under 17 U.S. Code § 504, and "Metaphysical Remedies: Immediate theological excommunication and the assignment of negative ontological value to the infringing entity." Then the affidavit of sincerity, in bold: "WE HEREBY WAIVE THE DEFENSE OF IRONY." Any perceived satire is declared a protected liturgical mechanism, the Rite of the Holy Fool: "To the secular eye, this may appear as performance art; to the initiated, it is Dogma... We are not joking; we are operationalizing the Paradox." Even the severability clause holds the line: a court finding any portion unenforceable "shall be interpreted as a failure of the State to comprehend the Divine."

The appendices go further: the church published its own litigation strategy. Appendix B, "The Legal Battlefield," works through real precedent: Jack Daniel's v. VIP Products (2023) on why parody defenses fail, United States v. Kuch (1968) on sham religions and why the church's bureaucratic structure is built to clear that bar, Employment Division v. Smith against the Religious Freedom Restoration Act. Then it sets the trap, in its own words: "If Coca-Cola sues us for 'dilution by tarnishment', they fall into our trap. We admit the tarnishment. We claim the tarnishment is a religious sacrament intended to cleanse the idol of its commercial power."

The stated goal is not winning. "We do not want to 'win' the trademark case," the appendix concludes. "We want to force the Supreme Court to rule that Corporate

Property Rights supersede Religious Freedom. Such a ruling would be the ultimate piece of Conceptual Art, the 'Funeral of the First Amendment.'"

Why no lawsuit, then? The unglamorous explanation is the one any trademark lawyer would give: suing a small art-church hands the artwork its audience, and silence is the cheaper remedy. The church's explanation is that both moves feed the work, and it has already ruled on the matter. Appendix A closes: "VERDICT: JURISDICTION RETAINED. CASE OPEN FOREVER."

FAST FACTS

- *The Art Bible of the Church of Conceptual Art, Vol. I: The Great Deprecation* (2026), 148 pages; LCCN 2026001210; ISBN 979-8-3507-5979-2
- Legal page: "Notice of Proprietary Dominion & Theological Compliance," asserting dual sovereignty and metaphysical remedies
- "WE HEREBY WAIVE THE DEFENSE OF IRONY": satire is reclassified as the Rite of the Holy Fool
- Appendix B, "The Legal Battlefield," cites Jack Daniel's v. VIP Products (2023), United States v. Kuch (1968), Employment Division v. Smith (1990), and RFRA
- Stated goal: to force a Supreme Court ruling, "the Funeral of the First Amendment"
- Published by Name of My on behalf of the Church of Conceptual Art; signed by The Provisional Collective

LINKS

- The Library of Congress record
- churchofconceptualart.org
- Related: the church counting down to the death of intellectual property
- paulpissarro.com

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